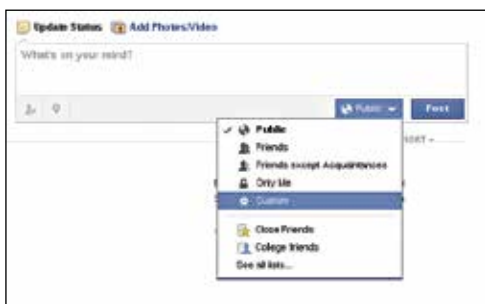


society which does not take online talk too intensely and seriously. Someday, that would change though and perhaps very soon. If a person whom you insulted online files up a case against you in the court, you could be charged and punished accordingly as and when you are proved to be the culprit (and you will eventually be, if you did it). Remember that when you are online, communication with mere text which cannot carry any emotion or mood in which you write it. Articulation of your writing style is needed to suit the environment of the talk to make the text convey really what it means and yet, depending on the understanding of the language by someone who reads the same, it might appear objectionable. Hence we repeat: treat your online mates with respect.

Don't underestimate your audience's size or wits

When was the last time you changed the privacy settings of your post? Last month or last hour? And hey, when did you update your status last anyway? Do these things matter? Well, yes they do. If they did not, we would not be wasting ink and paper on it. Social networking sites have become a business place for the simple reason - wherever there are people talking, business blooms. The inflammatory post you make about your harsh boss be better not shared with your office colleagues unless you really trust them. Just like in real world, it is important to categorize your friends online. If you have



not, please do so now to avoid problems.

While you can have control over your friend list, you cannot have any control over the number, diversity and involvement of other people in a group. In such cases, your post or comment would be seen by a lot

Do care for who you share your thoughts with

of other people depending on the type of group it was made in, the strength of the group in terms of number of members and the randomness of the website's notification system. If any one of those who watched your post feel offended enough to file an official report against you with the police or in court, difficult times may follow.